“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 13

The Stories of Jagadānanda Paṇḍita and Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I take shelter of Gaura, whose mind and body, though wasted by the pain born of separation from Kṛṣṇa, blossomed again through His ecstatic emotions.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In this way, in the company of Jagadānanda, Mahāprabhu tasted the waves of love in many ways.

4 His mind and body were wasted by the sorrow of separation from Kṛṣṇa, yet at times, absorbed in ecstatic emotion, the Lord would blossom again.

5 He lay on dried banana bark, and His body was very thin. His bones pressed against the bark, and His whole body ached.

6 Seeing this, all the devotees were deeply grieved. Jagadānanda could not bear it, and he devised a remedy.

7 He brought fine cloth, dyed it with red ochre and stuffed it with the cotton of the silk-cotton (*śimula*) tree.

8 He put a mattress and a pillow into Govinda's hands and told him, "Have the Lord lie down on these."

9 Jagadānanda said to Svarūpa Gosāñi, "Today please go yourself and have the Lord lie down on them."

10 At bedtime Svarūpa stayed right there. But when the Lord saw the mattress and pillow, He became angry.

11 He asked Govinda, "Who had this made?" But when He heard Jagadānanda's name, His heart shrank back in apprehension.

12 He had Govinda put the mattress away and lay down on the banana bark.

13 Svarūpa said, "It is Your will—what can I say? But if You reject the bed, the Paṇḍita will be deeply hurt."

14 The Lord said, "Then bring a bedstead too and set it up! Jagadānanda wants Me to enjoy worldly pleasures.

15 I am a *sannyāsī*; I must lie on the ground. For Me to have a bedstead, a mattress and a pillow would be a disgrace—a shaven head (*mastaka-muṇḍana*)."

16 Svarūpa Gosāñi came and told the Paṇḍita, and when Jagadānanda heard it, he was deeply grieved.

17 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi devised a way. He brought a great quantity of dry banana leaves.

18 Tearing them again and again with his nails, he shredded them very fine and filled the Lord's outer cloths (*bahirvāsa*) with them.

19 In this way he made two pieces of bedding (*oḍana-pāḍana*), and only after much persuasion did the Lord accept them.

20 The Lord lay on them, and seeing this, everyone was happy. But Jagadānanda remained deeply unhappy, inwardly and outwardly.

21 Jagadānanda had long wished to go to Vṛndāvana, but the Lord would not give him permission, and so he could not set out.

22 Without showing his inner sorrow outwardly, he asked the Lord for permission to go to Mathurā.

23 The Lord said, “You will go to Mathurā angry with Me. Laying the blame on Me, you will become a beggar.”

24 Clasping the Lord’s feet, Jagadānanda said, “For a long time I have wished to go to Vṛndāvana.

25 Without Your permission I could not go. Now please give me permission; I will surely go.”

26 Out of love, the Lord would not agree to his going, but he asked the Lord for permission again and again.

27 The Paṇḍita appealed to Svarūpa Gosāñi: “For a long time my heart has been set on going to Vṛndāvana.

28 Without the Lord’s permission I cannot go there, and now He will not give me permission. He says, ‘You would go in anger.’

29 My wish to go there is natural. Please obtain the Lord’s permission for me—I humbly request you.”

30 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi submitted at the Lord's feet: "Jagadānanda greatly desires to go to Vṛndāvana.

31 He has asked You for permission again and again. Please give him permission: let him see Mathurā once and come back.

32 Just as he goes to Gauḍa to see Mother Śacī, so let him go once, see Vṛndāvana and return."

33 At Svarūpa Gosāñi's word the Lord gave His permission. He called Jagadānanda and instructed him:

34 "As far as Vārāṇasī you may travel the road freely. Beyond that, go carefully, in the company of *kṣatriyas* and others.

35 If they find a Gauḍīya alone, highwaymen (*bāṭapāḍa*) waylay him and bind him; they plunder everything, keep him bound and do not let him go on.

36 When you reach Mathurā, stay with Sanātana, and honour the feet of all the lords of Mathurā.[1]

37 Show them devotion from afar, but do not stay in their company. You cannot adopt their ways and conduct.

38 Visit the forests with Sanātana, and do not leave Sanātana's company for a moment.

39 Come back quickly; do not stay there long. Do not climb Govardhana to see Gopāla.

40 Tell Sanātana, 'I too am coming,' and let him prepare a place for Me in Vṛndāvana."

41 Saying this, the Lord embraced Jagadānanda, and Jagadānanda bowed at the Lord's feet and set out.

42 He took leave of all the devotees, and travelling on and on by the forest path, he came to Vārāṇasī.

43 There he met both Tapana Miśra and Candraśekhara, and they heard from him all the news of the Lord.

44 Coming to Mathurā, he met Sanātana, and in each other's company both were joyful at heart.

45 Sanātana showed him the twelve forests, and after seeing Mahāvana the two stayed in Gokula.

46 The two stayed together in Sanātana's cave, and the Paṇḍita would go to a temple to cook.

47 Sanātana would go begging in Mahāvana—sometimes at a temple, sometimes at the homes of *brāhmaṇas*.

48 Sanātana looked after all the Paṇḍita's needs. In Mahāvana he would beg food and drink, bring it and give it to him.

49 One day the Paṇḍita invited Sanātana. Having finished his daily duties, he put the cooking on the fire.

50 A great *sannyāsī* named Mukunda Sarasvatī had given Sanātana an outer cloth (*bahirvāsa*).

51 Sanātana tied that cloth around his head, came and sat at the door of Jagadānanda's lodging.

52 Seeing the red cloth, the Paṇḍita was overwhelmed with love, for he thought it was Mahāprabhu's gift (*prasāda*). He asked him,

53 "Where did you get this red cloth?" "Mukunda Sarasvatī gave it," Sanātana replied.

54 When he heard this, anger arose in the Paṇḍita's mind, and with the rice pot in his hand he came forward to strike him.

55 Sanātana, understanding him, was abashed. The Paṇḍita set the pot back on the stove and began to speak:

56 "You are one of Mahāprabhu's chief associates. No one else is as dear to Mahāprabhu as you.

57 Yet you wear another *sannyāsī*'s cloth on your head! Who could tolerate such a thing?"

58 Sanātana said, "O saintly Paṇḍita, great soul! No one is as dear to Caitanya as you.

59 Such steadfast faith in Caitanya befits you. If you had not shown it, how would I ever learn it?

60 I tied the cloth on my head in order to see this, and now I have seen that unprecedented love with my own eyes.

61 It is not fitting for a Vaiṣṇava to wear red cloth. I shall give it to some stranger—what use is it to me?"

62 When he had finished cooking, Jagadānanda offered the food to Caitanya, and then the two sat down and honoured the *prasāda*.

63 After taking *prasāda*, the two embraced and wept in separation from Caitanya.

64 In this way he stayed in Vṛndāvana for two months, but the sorrow of separation from Caitanya was more than he could bear.

65 He gave Sanātana Mahāprabhu's message: "I too am coming. Prepare a place for Me to stay."

66 Then Jagadānanda Paṇḍita asked leave, and Sanātana gave him some gifts for the Lord:

67 sand from the place of the *rāsa* dance, a stone from Govardhana, dried ripe *pīlu* fruits and a garland of *guñjā* seeds.

68 Jagadānanda Paṇḍita set out with all these things, and Sanātana was distraught as he bade him farewell.

69 Sanātana thought of a place for the Lord and found a temple (*maṭha*) on the Dvādaśāditya mound.

70 The Gosāñi repaired that place and kept it ready, and in front of the temple he built a thatched shed.

71 Jagadānanda went quickly back to Nīlācala, and the Lord, together with the devotees, was overjoyed.

72 He bowed to the Lord's feet and met everyone, and Mahāprabhu embraced him tightly.

73 In Sanātana's name the Paṇḍita offered obeisance to the Lord, and he presented all the gifts—dust from the place of the *rāsa* dance and the rest.

74 The Lord kept all the gifts but distributed the *pīlu* fruits, and everyone ate them with delight, calling them “the fruit of Vṛndāvana.”

75 Those who knew the fruit began to suck the stones, but the Gauḍīyās who did not know it chewed the *pīlu* and swallowed it.

76 Their mouths were stung with pungency, and their tongues burned. Such was one *līlā* in the eating of the *pīlu* of Vṛndāvana.

77 Everyone rejoiced at Jagadānanda’s return. Thus the Lord enjoyed His pastimes at Nīlācala.

78 One day, as the Lord was going to Yameśvara-ṭoṭā, a *devadāsī* began to sing.

79 In a very sweet voice she was singing a song of the *Gīta-govinda* in the Gurjarī *rāgiṇī*, a song that steals the mind of the world.

80 Hearing the song from afar, the Lord became absorbed in ecstasy, not knowing at all who was singing, a woman or a man.

81 In His ecstasy the Lord ran to meet the singer. On the way He went straight into a hedge of *sij* shrubs and forced His way through it.

82 Thorns pierced His body, but He knew nothing of it! In great haste Govinda ran after Him.

83 The Lord was running on, and the woman was only a little way off, when Govinda caught the Lord in his arms, crying, “It is a woman singing!”

84 Hearing the word “woman,” the Lord returned to external consciousness, and He turned back and went the same way.

85 The Lord said, “Govinda, today you have saved My life. Had I touched a woman, it would have been My death.

86 I shall never be able to repay this debt to you.” Govinda said, “It is Jagannātha who protects. What am I, insignificant as I am?”

87 The Lord said, “Govinda, stay with Me. Wherever I am, be careful to protect Me.”

88 Saying this, the Lord turned back and went to His residence. Hearing of it, Svarūpa and the others were greatly alarmed at heart.

89 Meanwhile Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya, the son of Tapana Miśra, left all his affairs and set out to see the Lord.

90 He set out from Kāśī by the road through Gauḍa, and a servant went with him, carrying his bag.

91 On the way he was met by Rāmadāsa Viśvāsa, a *kāyastha* of the *Viśvāsa-khānā* and a trusted officer of the king.

92 He was expert in all the scriptures and a teacher of the *Kāvya-prakāśa*, a great Vaiṣṇava, a worshipper of Raghunātha (Rāma).

93 Night and day, through all eight *praharas*, he chanted the name of Rāma. Giving up everything, he had set out to see Jagannātha.

94 He met Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa on the way, and he went along carrying the Bhaṭṭa’s bag on his head.

95 He rendered various services and massaged his feet, and this made Raghunātha uneasy at heart.

96 “You are a great man, a *paṇḍita*, a *mahā-bhāgavata*. Do not serve me; just walk happily with me.”

97 Rāmadāsa said, “I am a lowly *śūdra*! To serve a *brāhmaṇa* is my own *dharma*.

98 Do not feel uneasy: I am your servant. When I serve you, my heart is filled with joy.”

99 Saying this, he carried the bag and served him, and night and day he chanted the *tāraka-mantra* of Raghunātha (Rāma), the mantra that delivers.

100 In this way Raghunātha came to Nīlācala; he went to the Lord’s feet and met Him with eager joy.

101 Offering obeisance like a rod, the Bhaṭṭa fell at His feet, and the Lord, calling “Raghunātha!”, embraced him.

102 He conveyed the obeisances of Miśra and Śekhara, and Mahāprabhu asked for news of them all.

103 “It is good that you have come. Go and see the lotus-eyed Lord (Jagannātha), and today you will take *prasāda* here with Me.”

104 Through Govinda the Lord had a lodging given to him, and He introduced him to Svarūpa and the other devotees.

105 In this way he stayed with the Lord for eight months, and by the Lord’s mercy his joy increased day by day.

106 From time to time he invited Mahāprabhu, cooking rice at home and various vegetable dishes.

107 Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa was highly expert in cooking; whatever he cooked became like nectar.

108 With great satisfaction the Lord would eat, and the Bhaṭṭa would eat the remnants on the Lord's plate.

109 When Rāmadāsa first met the Lord, Mahāprabhu did not show him much mercy.

110 At heart he desired liberation, and he was proud of his learning. The Lord knows every heart: He is Bhagavān, who knows all.

111 Rāmadāsa then settled at Nīlācala and taught the *Kāvya-prakāśa* to the Paṭṭanāyaka family.

112 When he had stayed eight months, the Lord bade the Bhaṭṭa farewell and forbade him, saying, "Do not marry.

113 Go and serve your aged mother and father, and study the *Bhāgavata* under a Vaiṣṇava.

114 Come to Nīlācala once more." Saying this, the Lord placed the garland from His own neck around his neck.

115 Embracing him, the Lord bade him farewell, and the Bhaṭṭa, overflowing with love, began to weep.

116 Asking leave of Svarūpa and the other devotees, and having received the Lord's permission, the Bhaṭṭa came to Vārāṇasī.

117 For four years he served his father and mother at home, and he studied the *Bhāgavata* under a Vaiṣṇava *paṇḍita*.

118 When his father and mother departed this world at Kāśī, he became detached, left home and all, and came to the Lord again.

119 As before, he stayed with the Lord for eight months, and when the eight months had passed, the Lord again gave him His order:

120 “Raghunātha, by My order go to Vṛndāvana. Go there and stay with Rūpa and Sanātana.

121 Read the *Bhāgavata* and always take the name of Kṛṣṇa. Very soon Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān, will bestow His mercy on you.”

122 Saying this, the Lord embraced him, and by the Lord’s mercy he became intoxicated with love for Kṛṣṇa.

123 At a festival the Lord had received Jagannātha’s *tulasī-mālā*, fourteen cubits long, and a plain roll of betel (*chuṭā-pāna-viḍā*).

124 The Lord gave him that *mālā* and the plain betel, and he kept the *mālā*, regarding it as his worshipful Deity (*iṣṭa-deva*).

125 Taking the Lord’s permission, he went to Vṛndāvana, and on arriving there he took shelter of Rūpa and Sanātana.

126 In Rūpa Gosvāmī’s assembly he would recite the *Bhāgavata*, and as he read, his mind would lose its hold, overwhelmed with love.

127 By the Lord’s mercy, tears, trembling and a faltering voice would come; tears would veil his eyes, and he could not go on reading.

128 His voice was like the cuckoo’s, and in it lay many *rāgas*: reading a single verse, he would pass through three or four *rāgas*.

129 When he read or heard of Kṛṣṇa's beauty and sweetness, he was overwhelmed with love and knew nothing else.

130 He surrendered himself at the feet of Govinda: Govinda's lotus feet were the treasure of his life.

131 Through his own disciple he had a temple built for Govinda, and he gave the Deity a flute, *makara*-shaped earrings and other ornaments.

132 He would not listen to worldly talk, nor speak it with his tongue. All the eight *praharas* of his day passed in talks of Kṛṣṇa, worship and the like.

133 He would not let the blameworthy deeds of a Vaiṣṇava reach his ears. "Everyone serves Kṛṣṇa"—this alone he knew.

134 At the time of remembrance (*smaraṇa*) he would tie around his neck the *mālā* given by Mahāprabhu, together with the *prasāda*.

135 By Mahāprabhu's mercy his love for Kṛṣṇa flowed unrestrained. This I have told; in it is the fruit of Caitanya's mercy.

136–137 I have told of Jagadānanda's journey to Vṛndāvana, and in the midst of it, of the Lord's hearing the *devadāsī*'s song, and of the great fruit of Mahāprabhu's mercy upon Raghunātha. Thus in one chapter I have told all three topics.

138 Whoever hears all these narrations with faith, Gaurahari gives him the wealth of love for Kṛṣṇa.

139 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Mathurāra svāmī-saba*, “the lords of Mathurā”: according to the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, the Caubes, the residents of Mathurā. The *Anubhāṣya* (verses 36–37) explains that they are devotees on the path of *rāga*, free from awareness of the Lord’s majesty, whom Jagadānanda, devoted to the mood of majesty, should honour from a distance. ↩